## MMSU's Commitment

***Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.***

**SDG 15.2.4 · Educational programmes on ecosystems**

*Offer educational programmes on ecosystems (looking at wild flora and fauna) for local or national communities.*

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year)

# MMSU Trains Coastal Towns on Mangrove Propagation, Management and Conservation

**PHOTO TO INSERT**

Seminar-workshop on mangrove propagation and management for coastal municipalities, Center for Flexible Learning, 27–28 October 2025.

`assets/mangrove_seminar_2025.jpg`

`Source: MMSU News, 5 Nov 2025 (article 2670) or the NbS mangrove project team`

*Seminar-workshop on mangrove propagation and management for coastal municipalities, Center for Flexible Learning, 27–28 October 2025.*

MMSU conducted a two-day Seminar-Workshop on Mangrove Propagation on October 27–28, 2025 at its Center for Flexible Learning for representatives of the coastal municipalities of Currimao, Pasuquin, Badoc and Burgos, Ilocos Norte, with officials of DENR-PENRO in attendance. The training was organized under the DOST-PCAARRD-funded nature-based solutions mangrove project led by Dr. Arlene Gonzales.

Sessions covered the importance of mangrove ecosystems, nature-based solutions for conservation, legal frameworks for mangrove protection, and the roles of the academe and local government units in community-based mangrove management. Participants were also trained in nursery management and advanced propagation techniques for Avicennia and Sonneratia species and other local mangrove varieties.

**Source**

- MMSU News, “MMSU trains Ilocos Norte coastal towns on mangrove propagation and management,” 5 November 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2670/mmsu-trains-ilocos-norte-coastal-towns-on-mangrove-propagation-and-management

## Farmers in Sarrat Trained to Propagate the Indigenous Alukon

**PHOTO TO INSERT**

Training on alukon (himbabao) propagation for farmers, Barangay 11 Sta. Rosa, Sarrat, 2 May 2025.

`assets/alukon_training_2025.jpg`

Source: MMSU News, 9 May 2025, or the Research Directorate

*Training on alukon (himbabao) propagation for farmers, Barangay 11 Sta. Rosa, Sarrat, 2 May 2025.*

On May 2, 2025, the MMSU Research and Extension Directorates trained 64 farmers in Barangay 11 Sta. Rosa, Sarrat, Ilocos Norte, on the propagation of alukon (himbabao), a Philippine indigenous vegetable tree. Barangay officials, members of the Task Force Dagger Special Operations Foundation and representatives of the local government unit also attended. The training was held in response to requests from the community.

Resource speakers Dr. Menisa Antonio, Engr. Josefa Pugat and Mr. Jayson Rasay of the Research Directorate presented recommended propagation strategies to establish sustained alukon production in the community and broaden the use of the crop for food and other applications.

**Source**

- MMSU News, “MMSU trains Sarrat farmers on alukon propagation,” 9 May 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-trains-sarrat-farmers-on-alukon-propagation

# Community Foodscapes as Learning Gardens for Indigenous Plants



*Partners receive indigenous food plant planting materials for the Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks, World Food Day 2025.*

In October 2025, in celebration of World Food Day, the MMSU Extension and Research Directorates established the second batch of Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks for Indigenous Food Plants at Eladio V. Barangan Memorial Elementary School, San Nicolas, Ilocos Norte. Barangay officials of San Roque and Parut, Vintar, agricultural extension workers, school leaders and community representatives took part.

The foodscape sites serve as seedbanks and learning gardens that encourage knowledge sharing and sustainable farming practices. Communities receive planting materials and technical assistance to cultivate indigenous crops such as kapaskapas, alokon, pako, dalayap, wild singkamas and roselle, conserving indigenous food resources across Ilocos Norte.

**Source**

- MMSU Extension Directorate, “MMSU expands indigenous food plant seedbanks and foodscapes in LGUs,” October 2025 https://extension.mmsu.edu.ph/news/show/389/mmsu-expands-indigenous-food-plant-seedbanks-and-foodscapes-in-lgus
- MMSU SDG 15 Life on Land report (2025), Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking